

Document 0. 80/20 Priority Map — Read This First

The single most important page in this suite. If you have limited revision time, your goal is not to learn everything — it is to maximise marks per hour. This map tells you what to study, in what order, and why.

The A-Worthy Rule. 80% of A-grade marks come from ~20% of topics. The mistake most students make is spending equal time on every chapter. Your time is scarce. Allocate it to topics that are tested heavily and where you can move from a B to an A. Use this map to do exactly that.

Section A. Topic Frequency in 9570 (TYS analysis, 10-year window)

Topic	P1 freq.	P2 freq.	Why it's high-yield
DD/SS Price Mechanism	Very High	Very High	Foundation for every micro question and many macro Qs (X, M, FX).
Externalities + Policies	Very High	Very High	Always tested. Frameworks transfer to merit/demerit goods.
Market Failure (other sources)	High	High	Easy marks if you know the source-and-policy match.
Market Structures	Med	Very High	Big Paper 2 essays; learn 4 structures cold.
Government Intervention (taxes, subsidies, price controls)	Very High	High	Welfare areas appear in nearly every CSQ.
AD-AS + Multiplier	Very High	Very High	The lens for every macro question. Internalise the 7-step.
Inflation (causes + policies)	Very High	Very High	High-stakes recent (2022–23). Combine with MAS.
Unemployment (types + policies)	High	High	Pairs with growth. SkillsFuture / JGI win marks.
Economic Growth (4 types)	Very High	Very High	Always in macro Paper 2. Sustained vs sustainable vs inclusive.
BOP + Trade	High	High	CA surplus / deficit consequences; J-curve.
Exchange Rate (MAS)	Very High	Very High	Most-tested Singapore-specific topic. Six factors framework.
Fiscal Policy	Med	High	Always in policy-mix essays.
Monetary Policy (MAS)	Very High	Very High	Same topic as exchange rate; learn together.
Supply-Side Policies	Med	Very High	Long-run policy mix essays.
International Trade + Protectionism	Med	Med	CA causes (loss of comp advantage); CSQ application.
Globalisation	Low	Med	Lower yield. Read only after the above.

NOTE: Frequencies are practitioner consensus from a 10-year window of past prelim and A-Level papers. "Very High" = appears in $\geq 70\%$ of papers; "High" = 40–70%; "Med" = 15–40%; "Low" = $< 15\%$.

Section B. Tiered Study Plan — Allocate Your Time

Tier 1 (must master): 60% of revision time. DD/SS, externalities, government intervention, AD-AS multiplier, inflation, exchange rate & monetary policy, sustained growth.

Tier 2 (high-value): 25% of revision time. Market structures, unemployment, BOP, fiscal policy, supply-side policies, merit/demerit/public goods, elasticities.

Tier 3 (top-up): 10% of revision time. International trade, protectionism, globalisation, info failure, factor immobility.

Tier 4 (quick reads): 5% of revision time. Definitions only, command words, signposting phrases, evaluation toolkit.

Section C. Revision Sequence (12-week plan compressed to study-time order)

Week 1–2. Master DD/SS + externalities frameworks. Drill the verbatim 7-step until you can write it in 4 minutes.

Week 3. Government intervention (all 4 instruments + welfare areas).

Week 4. AD-AS framework + multiplier numerical and AS/AD diagrams.

Week 5. Inflation + Deflation (demand-pull, cost-push, deflationary spiral).

Week 6. Exchange rate (6 factors) + MAS framework + monetary policy.

Week 7. Sustained / sustainable / inclusive growth.

Week 8. Market structures + market failure (other sources).

Week 9. Unemployment + BOP + fiscal policy.

Week 10. International trade + protectionism + supply-side.

Week 11. Practice papers + error log review.

Week 12. Cram pack (Doc 35) only. No new content. Sleep.

Section D. Per-Topic Marks-Grab Cheat Codes

Every micro CSQ part:

1. Define the term.
2. Draw the diagram (label all curves, equilibrium points, shaded welfare areas).
3. Apply the 7-step framework verbatim.
4. Anchor to the extract data point (quote a number with units).
5. Singapore example for additional context.

Every 8+ mark part: include at least *two* of: (1) elasticity caveat, (2) magnitude qualifier, (3) time-horizon split (short-run vs long-run), (4) C-E-F test, (5) alternative policy comparison.

Every essay (b) part: structure = *thesis* (3 reasons), *anti-thesis* (2 reasons), *evaluation* (3 of: magnitude, conditionality, alternative, distributional, time horizon), *synthesis conclusion* (take a stance, qualify with the binding context).

Section E. The 10 Frameworks You Cannot Afford Not To Memorise

1. **DD/SS price adjustment** (7 steps × 5 cases) — Doc 5
2. **Externality** (7 steps + diagram memorisation) — Doc 7
3. **Indirect tax / subsidy welfare** — Doc 10
4. **Multiplier process** (7 steps) — Doc 11
5. **Demand-pull inflation** (5 steps) — Doc 13
6. **Cost-push inflation** (5 steps) — Doc 13
7. **Cyclical unemployment** (6 steps) — Doc 14
8. **Sustained growth** (6 steps) — Doc 15
9. **Exchange rate, 6 D/S factors** — Doc 17
10. **MAS exchange-rate-centred MP** (3 levers) — Docs 17 + 19

Section F. Self-Diagnostic — Are You On Track?

For each Tier 1 topic, ask: Can I, without notes, in <8 minutes, (i) draw the canonical diagram fully labelled, (ii) reproduce the 5/6/7-step framework, and (iii) cite at least one Singapore policy example?

If *yes for all* on Tier 1 topics, you are A-grade ready — shift effort to Tier 2.

If *no on three or more*, you have a fluency problem, not a knowledge problem. **Re-attempt past CSQs** on those topics under timed conditions, not more reading.

Final principle. The student who passes the exam is not the one who knows the most. It is the one who can deploy the right framework at the right time, under time pressure, with a complete diagram, anchored to context. Optimise for *deployment speed*, not coverage.